



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Coram Deo Academy

School Website: <https://www.coramdeo.academy/>

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Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

ACCS: **MEMBER** SCL: **MEMBER**

Any school that belongs to the Association of Classical Christian Schools (ACCS) and the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because both organizations require adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Coram Deo Academy (Kennewick, WA 99336) presents a clearly Christian, classical-oriented program anchored in the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) with explicit mission, vision, and curricular framing that align with core classical-school indicators. Public materials emphasize Christ-centered formation, truth-goodness-beauty as real and knowable, and a disciplined, Gemeinschaft-oriented approach to learning. Notable strengths include a stated mission to partner with Christian families, a public articulation of the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric progression, and visible evidence of school-wide efforts to integrate religious formation with intellectual formation (e.g., senior thesis in rhetoric, Shakespeare/Great-Books-style offerings, and a structured campus culture). Several elements that are commonly associated with a more robust classical program—explicit Great Books reading, an explicit, liturgical communal life, and a fully articulated Quadrivium or Scholé-centered pedagogy—are present but less explicit in the public-facing materials. Overall, the school lands between CLASSICAL and SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL, leaning toward CLASSICAL due to its explicit Christian-theological framing, Trivium-focused curriculum, and strong partnerships with families, while showing room for fuller articulation of some classical markers (e.g., explicit reference to Great Books as a sustained curricular throughline beyond Shakespeare-based events, and broader liturgical practices).

- Aggregate rating: CLASSICAL
- Key takeaway: CDA demonstrates a coherent classical Christian orientation with a clearly enacted Trivium pathway, theology-integrated mission, and active parent/community engagement. The strongest opportunities to “move the needle” would involve more explicit articulation of a Great Books approach across disciplines, a broadened sense of liturgical/community practices, and clearer identification of upper-level pedagogical practices (e.g., Socratic seminars and formal rhetoric work) as a systemic, school-wide habit rather than primarily in limited program pages. However, the current public materials already reflect a robust classical-Christian formation ecology.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- Public materials emphasize a Christ-centered, Bible-centered frame: “Everything we study finds its ultimate integrated center in the person and work of Jesus Christ. Everything we do is Coram Deo, a Latin phrase which means ‘in the presence of God’.”
- The mission and vision explicitly ground education in Scripture, the Bible as God’s Word, and a God-centered educational purpose: “Coram Deo Academy exists to partner with Christian parents and local churches in providing excellent, accessible, and classical education centered on the person and work

of Jesus Christ” and “The underlying philosophy of Coram Deo Academy is a complete belief in and adherence to the Bible as God’s Word.”

- The public-facing narrative ties virtue, worship, and sacred aims to the learning mission (e.g., “prepared for life” through a Gospel-centered classical education; “truth, goodness, and beauty” called out as real anchors in the Vision).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: truth, goodness, beauty; theology; Christ-centered education; Bible/Scripture; Coram Deo; liturgical/service-minded community language appears in mission/vision framing. These map to Positive Keywords in the Six Essential Elements lexicon (Truth/Goodness/Beauty; Theology; Liturgical/Communal ideas; Coram Deo as a liturgical-ecclesial frame). See the Positive Keyword inventories (e.g., truth, goodness, beauty; theology; liturgy; worship; coram deo) in the Six Essential Elements lexicon.
- Quantitative sense: multiple explicit matches to positive indicators (at least 6–8 concrete terms/phrases such as truth, goodness, beauty, Jesus Christ, Bible, Scripture, God, Coram Deo) and no explicit negative signals in this public-facing material within Element 1’s framing.
- Why this rating
- The materials repeatedly anchor education in a theologic frame, explicitly naming Jesus Christ and Scripture, and foregrounding a liturgical, worshipful, or communal orientation through the Coram Deo concept. This aligns strongly with the Positive Keywords for Element 1 (Transcendental moral realism; Grounded in Theology; Liturgical/Communal practices; etc.), and the absence (in public copy) of relativistic/anti-theist signals supports a CLASSICAL rating. See the glossary of Element 1 signals in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and the explicit statements above.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The school’s stated aim emphasizes formation of virtue and wisdom and a love for truth, goodness, and beauty as real, knowable goods. The Vision cites “truth, goodness, and beauty” and the Mission emphasizes a “classical education centered on” the person and work of Christ, pointing toward formation over mere information.
- The “Our Purpose” language anchors Bible-centered formation of character and life-long formation, not just vocational or information-transfer aims. The school asserts the Bible as governing life and education (biblical formation as telos).
- The senior thesis and rhetoric pathways signal a formation-oriented arc (memory, rhetoric, character-informed leadership) rather than a pure information-transfer emphasis.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty, liberal-arts-orientation (implicit through Trivium framing), scholé/restful pace implied via contemplative cadence in classical pedagogy.
- Negative indicators: minimal to none in public materials; the site does not foreground strictly “workforce prep” or 21st-century-skills language as primary telos.
- Quantitatively, identify multiple positive indicators (formation, virtue, wisdom, telos, truth/goodness/beauty). Negative indicators are not present in the public content for this category.
- Why this rating
- The content strongly reflects formation-of-character and the pursuit of enduring truths (the true, good, beautiful) rather than a narrow vocational goal. This maps to the Six Essential Elements’ Element 2 (Formation, telos, pursuit of truth/goodness/beauty) with explicit language such as the Vision’s emphasis on truth/goodness/beauty and the Bible-centered telos. Given the robust connections to Formation and Virtue signals, CLASSICAL is justified. See the lexicon’s Element 2 signals and the school’s formation-focused language.

Element 3: School Curriculum — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The public materials explicitly present the Grammar Stage (K–5), Logic Stage (6–8), and Rhetoric Stage (9–12) as a formal progression, i.e., the Trivium framework. This is a core Classical criterion.
- There are explicit references to Shakespeare and other Great Books-worthy material in promotional/event content (e.g., Shakespeare: Much Ado About Nothing; Fine Arts Night with Shakespeare scenes). This signals engagement with classic texts beyond modern social studies framing.
- However, Quadrivium elements are not explicitly named in public copy (e.g., arithmetic, geometry, music, astronomy as a formal Quadrivium). Great Books are evidenced through Shakespeare-centric and rhetoric-focused activity, but not consistently documented as an ongoing Great Books program across all disciplines. The site mentions classical education and the Trivium but does not universally articulate a sustained Great Books curriculum beyond select offerings. See the explicit “Grammar-/Logic/Rhetoric Stages” and Shakespeare/Fine Arts references.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Trivium terminology (grammar/logic/rhetoric); Great Books/Normative Western canon signals via Shakespeare events; emphasis on “liberal arts” framing in public text (through classical education language). The lexicon’s Element 3 signals (Seven Liberal Arts; Great Books; interdisciplinary structure) map onto what is visible here.
- Negative indicators present: Quadrivium explicit references are missing; broad, explicit Great Books program across all disciplines is not clearly documented in the public pages (though Shakespeare events exist). The presence of project-based or experiential-only pedagogy as a dominant framing is not evident in the public copy; but a lack of explicit, sustained Great-Books-throughout-curriculum language lowers the score toward SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL.
- Quantitative: several clear Trivium indicators plus some Great-Books signals, but not a fully explicit Quadrivium or “Great Conversation” across the curriculum in the public materials. Positive keyword hits exist, but not as fully comprehensive to meet all Category-3 Positive indicators in the classical rubric.
- Why this rating
- The school demonstrates core classical content (grammar/logic/rhetoric) and some Great Books alignment (Shakespeare events and classical texts), which supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL. The Quadrivium and a robust, explicit “Great Conversation” across disciplines are not as clearly documented, which keeps Element 3 from a full CLASSICAL rating. See the Trivium-based curriculum articulation and Shakespeare-related Great Books signals.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Lower/Grammar teaching is described as memory-oriented (grammar-stage focus) and memory-rich approaches, which aligns with traditional pedagogy (recitation/memory as a classical feature). The site notes “memory” and “repetition” in the Grammar Stage language.
- Upper School pedagogy includes Socratic discussion, seminars, or debates and rhetoric training, indicating a transition to more dialogic and rhetoric-focused pedagogy. The presence of a “senior thesis project” and rhetoric-stage emphasis suggests cultivated oratory and argumentation skills.
- Some areas (e.g., “restful learning” or “Scholé” as systemic pedagogy) are not explicitly described in the general public pages, though the vision emphasizes disciplined, thoughtful learning in a Scriptural framework. The presence of conversational/dialectic elements at the upper levels and song/chant or memory work in lower levels is not extensively documented in public pages beyond the general statements.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Socratic discussion/seminars and rhetoric; memory-based recitation concepts in the classical pedagogy lexicon are referenced in the broader Classical Education document and are implied by the three-stage Trivium and a Senior Thesis program. See the Element 4 Positive Keywords (Socratic dialogue; restfulness (Scholé); memorization/recitation; formation through

imitation) in the Six Essential Elements lexicon and the public text's emphasis on the Grammar-Logic-Rhetoric progression and Senior Thesis.

- Negative indicators: The public copy does not emphasize a fully "Scholé" restful cadence across the entire school, and there is limited explicit evidence of project-based or experiential-only pedagogy dominating (the evidence given is more the presence of classical pedagogy rather than its exclusive dominance). The lexicon flags "Lack of Memorization and Recitation" or "experiential learning dominance" as negative signals if they were present; CDA's public materials show more classical memory-based and rhetoric-based pedagogy, but not a complete emphasis on experiential-only methods.
- Quantitative: multiple tailored signals for both low-level memory-based pedagogy and upper-level Socratic/Rhetoric pedagogy exist, yielding a mixed but leaning toward classical in pedagogy. The presence of both arching grades (K–12) with different pedagogical modes justifies a SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rating.
- Why this rating
- The school exhibits classical pedagogy across grade bands (memory/recitation in the grammar stage; Socratic/dialogue/rhetoric in upper grades) with a senior-thesis element. Yet, the public materials do not consistently articulate a system-wide, fully integrated "Socratic seminars everywhere" or a uniform Scholé rhythm across the entire school, which would push the category to CLASSICAL. See the public articulation of Grammar/Logic/Rhetoric stages and upper-school pedagogy language.

Element 5: School Faculty — SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The site presents named leadership (e.g., Carolyn Johnson as Headmaster; administrative staff) and a sense of teachers as mentors who model Christian virtue. The public materials emphasize the leadership role and the school's mission-driven faculty culture in a Christian context rather than a formalized "living curriculum" portrait. See the Headmaster profile and staff descriptions, and the general faculty narrative in About/Staff materials.
- Public materials do not consistently present a formal "portrait of a teacher" or a "living curriculum" concept with explicit, across-the-board faculty development or peer-mented mentoring, though the mission and statements imply faculty as role models within a classical-Christian framework (the "headmaster," "staff" and mission narratives). The absence of a robust, explicit "faculty as living curriculum" statement in public pages yields a more modest Score.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: "teachers as models of virtue," "headmaster," "staff" and "mentorship" language appear in the broader classical lexicon and the school's staff pages. The Six Essential Elements lexicon includes "Teachers as Models of Virtue," "Mentorship and Collegiality," and "Portrait of a teacher/student" as positive signals. See the lexicon and the staff materials (Headmaster and staff pages).
- Negative indicators present: public materials do not consistently articulate a fully articulated "living curriculum" portrait or a robust, campus-wide faculty formation program beyond mission statements; the weekly teaching culture is not as explicitly described as a fully formed classical faculty portrait.
- Quantitative: several faculty-related signals exist but not a comprehensive, explicit, school-wide "living curriculum" framing; this supports SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL rather than CLASSICAL.
- Why this rating
- The presence of named leadership and a Christian faculty culture aligns with classical norms, but the public materials do not provide a fully detailed "model-teachers living curriculum" framework across all grades. See the leadership pages and mission-driven statements for the evidentiary basis.

Element 6: School Parents and Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Partnership with families is clearly stated as a core aim: "exists to partner with Christian parents and local churches..." and "parents as co-teachers" language is echoed in the "Partnership with Families"

framework in the Six Elements lexicon and in the school's pages about family involvement. Public materials explicitly highlight parental partnership and family engagement as a core principle.

- There is explicit volunteer policy: "Each family that has at least one child enrolled at CDA is asked to provide 20 hours of volunteer service per semester" (and a monetary alternative). This demonstrates active parental involvement as part of the school community.
- The school hosts family-oriented events (Open Houses, Fall Festival, Fine Arts Night, Fund Run) and invites family involvement; the event pages show broad family participation and campus openness, aligning with the "Open Campus/Parent Involvement" signals from the classical framework.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: "Partnership with Families"; "Parental engagement"; "family-centered learning"; "home-and-school connection"; "parent formation" language appears in the lexicon's category 6 positives, and the CDA materials demonstrate substantial parent involvement (volunteering, events, family participation). See the Six Essential Elements lexicon (Element 6: Parents and Community) and the CDA parent-involvement materials.
- The materials do not show any strong negative signals in this domain (no major consumerism framing; rather, they emphasize parents as collaborative co-educators).
- Quantitative: multiple positive indicators (explicit partnership language; explicit volunteer policy; open-campus events; family involvement). No overt negative signals in public content.
- Why this rating
- The school clearly foregrounds parent-teacher partnership and family formation as a central axis of education, consistent with classical pedagogy's emphasis on family formation and shared mission. This aligns with the Classical Elements' Element 6 signals. See the partnership language and parent-involvement policies.

Aggregate assessment

- Element 1: CLASSICAL
- Element 2: CLASSICAL
- Element 3: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 4: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 5: SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL
- Element 6: CLASSICAL

Overall, the school's six-category assessment yields CLASSICAL as the aggregate classification, with three clearly CLASSICAL signals (Religious/Metaphysical and Purpose; Parents & Community; explicit Trivium/grammar-logic-rhetoric pedagogy in some domains) and three that are SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL due to less explicit/generally-systematized Great Books, Quadrivium, and fully realized Scholé-paced pedagogy across the entire K–12 experience. Taken together, the overall posture is CLASSICAL.

What would move the needle (for SOMEWHAT categories)

- Element 3 (Curriculum): Increase explicit, school-wide articulation of a Great Books framework and an explicit Quadrivium integration or cross-disciplinary humanities thread that consistently connects history, literature, philosophy, and sciences across grades. Publish a formal Great Conversation plan balancing primary texts beyond Shakespeare, with cross-curricular links and a clear rationale for faculty training in classical content across disciplines. This would move Element 3 from SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL toward CLASSICAL.
- Element 4 (Pedagogy): Formalize and publicize a consistent, school-wide use of Socratic seminars, Harkness-style dialogues, and a school-wide Scholé cadence (restful learning) across K–12, with explicit teacher training and routine assessment of these methods. This would strengthen Element 4's alignment with CLASSICAL pedagogy.
- Element 5 (Faculty): Develop and publish a more explicit "living curriculum" portrait of the faculty and a formal faculty formation/mentorship program that demonstrates teachers as models of virtue and core components of the living curriculum. This would push Element 5 toward CLASSICAL.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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